

SWIGGY INSTAMART – REGAIN MARKET POSITION

Agile Product Management Report

Abstract

This document summarizes how agile & other modern development processes will help Swiggy Instamart create innovative offerings faster to gain more market share

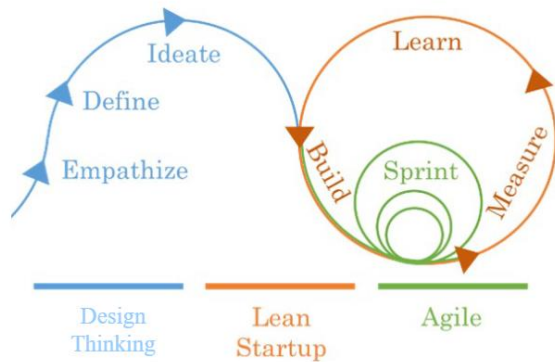
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Introduction

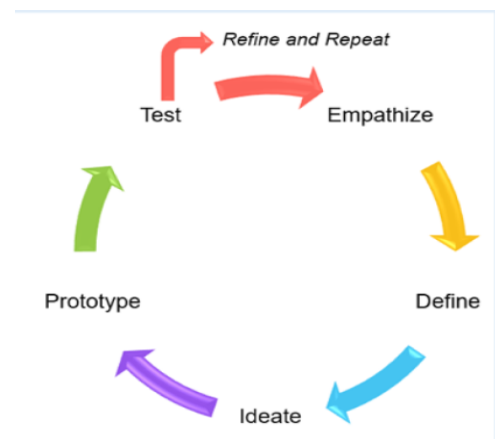
Swiggy Instamart who pioneered quick deliveries in India, is struggling today to firmly hold its market position owing to stiff competition and constant threat of new entrants in the industry. The detailed product strategy analysis and results of data analytics have revealed several areas of improvement and opportunities that Instamart can consider.



Given quick commerce industry is very competitive and constantly evolving, Instamart should act fast and use combination of all three modern development processes viz. design thinking, lean & agile to deliver its innovative ideas faster.

Design Thinking

Design thinking is a user-centric approach to find solutions & create innovative products. The key stages of this process are - empathise, define, ideate, prototype & test. In the empathise stage, we engage with customers to understand their needs, preferences & pain points.



For Instamart, the survey conducted to get user inputs for data analysis also captures their behavioural trends & expectations. Also, one-on-one discussions with users gave insights about how they use the app and what factors influence their decision making. The data thus gathered is synthesised to define the problem statement in more consumer-centric way.

The user research reveals that Over 60% of the respondents do only 25% of their monthly grocery/essentials shopping using the app. Also, half of the respondents spend less than Rs. 500 per order. This suggests that there is great scope to increase total share of groceries/essentials shopping on the app, which will eventually also increase the wallet share.

In the ideation stage, Instamart product team should brainstorm and generate innovative ideas to achieve this such as adding feature to collect customer suggestions/feedback about missing products, adding product assortments accordingly, increasing user engagement on the app by showing them relevant products, feature to smartly manage the household inventory by auto-filling the cart or timely suggesting the items to refill based on the usage & buying history. It

can also add weekly recipe planner on the app that can prompt the users to try new recipes and buy the essential ingredients from the app.

The survey data also reveals which products consumers do not prefer to buy online and the ones they wish to buy but are not available on these platforms. These products include fresh produce like fruits, vegetables, meat etc., region specific local products, bulk items like non-branded flour and rice. Instamart should definitely cater to these unmet needs of consumers by regularly engaging with them to find out their concerns regarding quality, availability, size, pricing etc., what features they desire and so on. To build trust with quality of fresh produce, videos of sourcing them with timestamp, location tag can be added on the app.

Instamart also needs to come up with more use-cases for different group of users to try out 10-minute deliveries. It should make its offerings attractive to micro segments of the targeted market such as homemakers, bachelors, elderly or sick people with no help at home, small catering or hotel vendors who need to buy groceries, fresh produce in bulk and so on. It should generate as many ideas as possible using different techniques like brainstorming, six hats, SCAMPER (substitute-combine-adopt-maximize or minimize-put to use-eliminate-rearrange) that guide logical & creating thinking to find tangible solutions.

All the ideas thus generated should be screened and scored on features with maximum value to customer and the organisation. With this exercise we get subset of ideas that can be prototyped and tested for design validity.

Prototype



Prototype helps to convey the product idea to its stakeholders and gathers feedback to improve the product design. It's a great way to test the idea for feasibility before investing a lot of resources on full development. The prototyping process also helps to explore solutions for functional/usability problems and potential features for the product.

Once the ideas for differentiated positioning, increasing percentage of shopping done via the app and attracting new customers are finalised, Instamart team should create prototypes to validate the design with users.

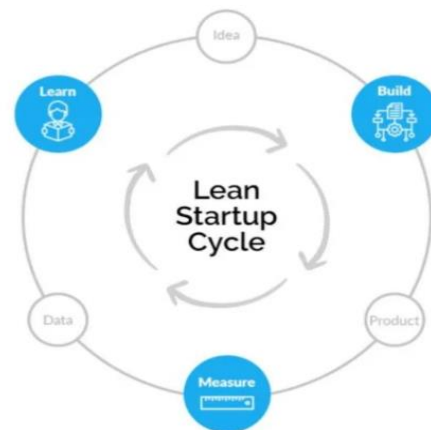
Instamart team should start with creating more low fidelity prototypes first followed by few with increased fidelity as the design assumptions are validated. Low fidelity prototypes like sketches, cards can be created to communicate differentiated value proposition. Mid fidelity prototypes cover the product in detail in at least one dimension. It looks more like the final product & supports visuals and interactions. Such prototypes can be created using clickable wireframes or tools like InVision, Framer. Instamart can use these types of prototypes to validate ideas on showcasing improved range of product assortments & specific product

categories based on user suggestions. High fidelity prototypes are very close to the real product in terms of content & feel. The innovative features to attract more users on the app should use high fidelity digital prototypes.

At all the stages, prototypes are iteratively tested with both internal & external users. The user feedback is carefully evaluated and necessary changes are done in the next version of the prototype product. This process continues until the prototype meets majority of the user expectations.

Lean Methodology

The Lean method helps to define value stream & identify key business outcomes to focus on. It regularly checks for customer feedback and is aware of market trends due to which, it prioritises delivering only what adds value at the right time. It follows continuous improvement cycle to deliver more value at lower cost by reducing waste and empowers people & builds trust amongst all stakeholders to make the entire process more efficient.



Quick commerce industry is all about innovating fast & delivering innovative products faster to get an edge in the competition. Lean product development method fits in properly here as it helps to reduce waste & delivery time and increase profit & value to customer. Instamart's strategic and data analysis indicates that operational efficiency is its core strength, that means lean and agile are already integral part of its execution.

In quick commerce operations, minimizing time wastage is of paramount importance. In order to achieve this, Instamart optimises each step of the order & inventory management process with the help of robust technology. Reducing waste of products at dark store/warehouse level, resources to run a dark store and overall increasing value to all the stakeholders including customers, merchant partners & delivery partners is important to make this business sustainable & profitable.

Roadmap

Product roadmap is execution plan of the product strategy in a given timeframe. It helps to identify customer needs & defines short-term & long-term goals to achieve during product lifecycle. Key elements of a product roadmap include product vision & strategy, strategy execution guide, stakeholders' alignment, scenario planning and product development status.

For Instamart, creating a differentiated positioning & getting new customers on board is most crucial to gain market share. Also, it should act fast to avoid losing more market share to the competitors. The roadmap should prioritise these items and allocate resources accordingly.

Product vision – Elevate quality of life for urban consumers by providing unparalleled convenience to them

Product strategy – Create differentiated positioning & gain more market share

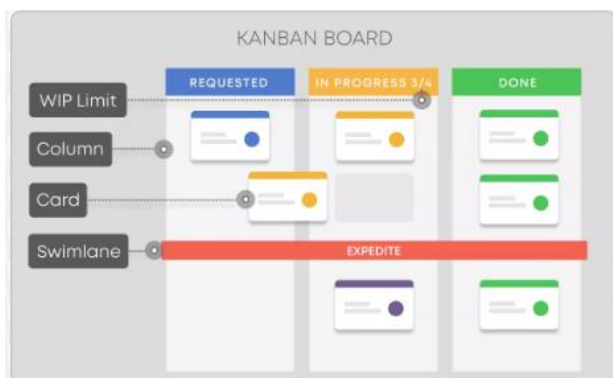
Product roadmap – The roadmap should include all the activities/tasks involved in creating differentiated positioning & getting new customers. A snapshot of the roadmap created using MS Excel is shown below:

Task Name	Priority	Due Date	Assignee Team	Status
Conduct design thinking workshops	High	03-Oct	Product Management, R&D	In Progress
Finalise & document differentiated positioning details	Medium	11-Jan	Product Management	To Do
Create prototypes & test	High	18-Oct	Product Management, Development	To Do
Implement feedback & finalise product feature design	High	22-Oct	Product Management, Development	To Do
Complete necessary operational & supply chain changes	High	31-Oct	Operations, Supply Chain Management	To Do
Create integrated marketing communication	Medium	31-Oct	Marketing	To Do
Update all stakeholders	Medium	05-Nov	Sales & Marketing	To Do
Roll out the changes	High	08-Nov	Development & Delivery	To Do
Monitor metrics to understand effectiveness of changes	Medium	08-Nov	Product Support	To Do

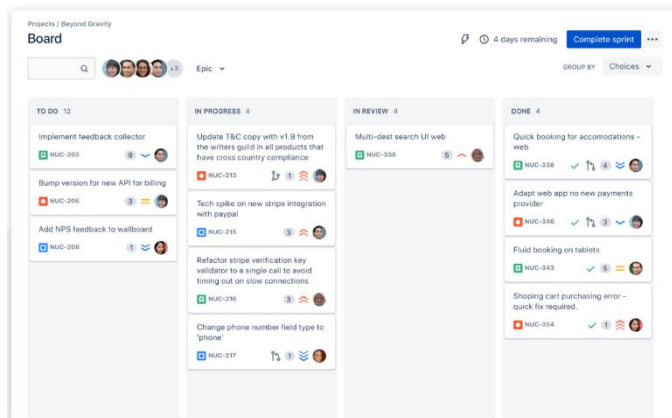
Each task should have team details for task allocation and timelines for completion. Sprint backlogs are created by referring the tasks prioritised in roadmap. The roadmap tasks or items are further divided into user stories where all specifications & implementation details are chalked out. Once the backlog is ready with prioritized user stories, development using agile frameworks can begin.

Agile Frameworks

Agile methodology helps to build better quality products by making incremental progress and incorporating feedback early on. It helps build products iteratively by prioritizing high value deliverables first. Scrum & kanban are common agile frameworks used for execution.



Kanban helps to visualize work, limit work in progress items & maximize efficiency by reducing completion time. A card represents work item that can be completed in entirety by a team member in specified time period. The columns are development stages that each card goes through.



Scrum implements fixed interval work cycles called sprints to complete shippable work. The feedback is incorporated to evolve design & build products that have higher acceptance. Scrum consists of a product owner, scrum master & engineering team. Product owner creates product backlog in form of user stories & prioritises them.

Instamart can use any of these frameworks to make incremental progress on developing new features to attract customers and expand product portfolio based on customer feedback.

In design thinking phase, brainstorming, finalising design & creating specification documents should be done iteratively for each problem statement & passed on to development. In development phase, prioritize feature backlog, do effort estimation for user stories and plan sprints to make incremental progress on delivering features. Closely monitor the progress & revisit priorities if needed. Agile also helps to incorporate any new changes as required by rapidly changing market.

A sample sprint for Instamart can look like this -

Sprint Goal – Build features on Instamart app to attract new users

User Stories:

1. As a user, I want to buy local brands of grocery products so that I can get the products that I am used to
2. As a user, I would like to get promotional offers/discounts on a new platform so that I don't need to pay high charges before I am sure about the service & product quality
3. As a homemaker, I want to buy vegetables in small quantities and preferably in combos so that I can buy them fresh whenever needed & in reasonable price

Each user story has tasks for cross functional team members. Scrum follows ceremonies like sprint planning, refinement (or grooming), daily standup, review & retrospective to ensure sprint goal is achieved within the set timeframe. Multiple scrum teams can work on different user stories in parallel. In this case, identifying dependencies is crucial.

Conclusion

Quick commerce industry is rapidly evolving with consumers changing their preferences and more and more players eager to enter this space. In a market crowded with competent competitors it is crucial to constantly innovate to find unique product offerings and execute it ahead of the competitors.

With the combination of design thinking for user-centric approach, lean to minimize waste, time to market & increase value and agile to iteratively & continuously make progress on the deliverables is the best strategy to stay ahead in the competition.